Key finding 1

Workforce benefits remain at the heart of the employee value proposition — and expectations continue to rise.

All industry stakeholders recognize the value of benefits and their power to attract and retain workers in what remains a tight labor market. Similarly, the value of a fully engaged, happy, healthy and productive workforce is well understood. So, it's no surprise that most employers expect to offer more benefits in the future, according to our findings.

Expanding benefits for workers: In a time of widespread economic uncertainty and high inflation combined with a workforce that features five generations, workers' continued reliance on benefits and their rising interest in more options is to be expected. Much like the experiences offered by other sectors, employees are looking for more flexibility and control in choosing the benefits that are right for their unique lifestyles and situations. Thus, there's every reason to believe benefits will only get more important to companies looking to attract and retain the workers they need to succeed. Our results show that the future workforce will require more freelance and gig workers, who are also increasingly interested in accessing benefits. See *sidebar*.

An overwhelming majority of employers — 84% overall and 95% of large employers — feel that benefits are necessary to attract key talent. More than half (57%) of small employers and 67% of large organizations expect to offer more benefits in the future. *See Figure 1*.

Figure 1

Companies plan to offer more benefits in five years.

QUESTION: In five years, do you think your company will be offering fewer, the same or more benefits than it does now?



